Russell Dudek

Enterprise AI Candidate Thesis

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https://russelldudek.github.io/PNC/

CANDIDATE THESIS

Scale the work. Not just the prompt.

Role objective. Turn a multi-function backlog of AI opportunities into a governed portfolio of secure, testable workflows—using the simplest approved capability, preserving human authority, and measuring completed business outcomes.

WHAT THE CONVERSATION CLARIFIED

Portfolio before isolated pilots

Demand spans Enterprise Change, shared-services finance, supply chain and procurement, and realty. A common intake and prioritization system should precede scarce engineering commitments.

Integration-led environment

Oracle, Ariba, IBM products, vendor systems, custom services, and shared data make source authority, lineage, identity, and integration central design concerns.

Approved capability boundary

Microsoft 365 Copilot, GitHub Copilot, and governed vendor features are practical starting points. Custom engineering should earn its added complexity.

Governance shapes delivery posture

Strict data-loss, ingress, egress, security, and approval controls make offline, sandbox, shadow, draft-only, and human-reviewed modes legitimate paths to evidence.

My operating thesis

A production prompt is one component inside a controlled workflow. The durable unit of scale carries business intent, approved context, tool authority, evaluation evidence, human decision rights, and an operating record.

AI WORK CONTROL ENVELOPE

1 · Business intent

Completed outcome, accountable owner, users, baseline friction, consequence, and scope boundary.

2 · Approved context

Authoritative sources, lineage, access, freshness, data classification, and no-answer behavior.

3 · Tool authority

Least privilege, allowlisted actions, identity inheritance, reversibility, limits, and escalation.

4 · Evaluation evidence

Task success, groundedness, completeness, conflicts, edge cases, refusal, injection, and regression.

5 · Human decision

Named review, approval, exception, override, accountability, and stop authority.

6 · Operating record

Completed outcomes, edits, overrides, failures, recovery, cost, adoption, and source gaps.

PORTFOLIO-TO-PROOF SEQUENCE

Listen › **Map demand** › **Classify options** › **Select proof** › **Evaluate safely** › **Standardize learning**

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VERIFIED TRANSFERABILITY

Experience where technology meets accountable work.

CAPABILITY DISPOSITION

Existing Copilot
Use an approved capability when it satisfies the work and controls.

Vendor AI
Use when it adds governed, differentiated value beyond generic model access.

Deterministic automation
Prefer rules, integration, search, or process redesign when more reliable.

Bounded custom
Build only when unique logic, integration, controls, or reuse justify it.

Hold or reject
Stop when ownership, evidence, economics, data, or controls are insufficient.

EVIDENCE FOR THE WORK

Role need	Verified evidence	How it transfers
Translate process into engineering work	Vape-Jet cross-system operating transformation; Amazon standard work; Compunetics technical programs.	Begin with the completed outcome, workflow friction, exceptions, systems, data, authority, and measurable baseline.
Design AI-assisted workflows	DudeWorth structured context, retrieval, agentic workflow, human judgment, escalation, evaluation, and governance patterns.	Treat prompts, retrieval, and tools as versioned components inside a bounded operating design.
Operate under consequence	Compunetics quality systems; ZeusVu regulated autonomous operations; Vape-Jet quality and engineering issue flow.	Define evidence, permissions, owners, review, fallback, recovery, and stop conditions before expanding authority.
Drive adoption and learning	Amazon 24/7 operating mechanisms; Vape-Jet dashboards, standard work, training, and accountability.	Measure completed outcomes, user behavior, overrides, rework, recurring friction, and the burden of sustaining the workflow.

APPLIED EXAMPLE · PROACTIVE SUPPORT INTELLIGENCE

Vape-Jet issue-to-resolution workflow

Machine telemetry, field information, customer context, service history, Jira, Slack, HubSpot, Odoo, and internal knowledge can leave support intake incomplete and engineering handoffs slow. A bounded workflow can assemble approved context, identify missing information, classify and route the issue, recommend likely root-cause families, and prepopulate the work record while engineering, quality, safety, and customer decisions remain human-controlled. The evidence belongs in intake delay, completeness, duplicate touches, backlog age, recurring failure patterns, resolution time, review corrections, and user acceptance—not in the volume of generated text.

APPROVED-TOOL OPERATING PRINCIPLE

The approved toolset changes implementation choices, not the operating method. Start with the decision, workflow, authoritative data, human authority, consequence, and evaluation need. Use Microsoft 365 Copilot, GitHub Copilot, or a governed vendor feature when sufficient; use deterministic automation when it is more reliable; require a bounded custom workflow to justify its added integration, monitoring, support, and change burden.

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OPERATING EVIDENCE AND DISCOVERY

Measure what changes the work.

BALANCED EVIDENCE OF VALUE

Business outcome
Cycle time, queue delay, labor/search time, rework, errors, exceptions, and completed outcome.

Quality and trust
Task success, groundedness, completeness, source conflicts, corrections, refusal, and regression.

Risk and authority
Access events, sensitive-data handling, overrides, escalation, intervention, rollback, and recovery.

Adoption
Use, abandonment, acceptance, repeat use, training, support, and review burden.

Economics
Licensing, inference, integration, monitoring, support, human review, and cost per accepted outcome.

Reuse
Shared components, regression coverage, adaptation burden, ownership, and transferable learning.

QUESTIONS FOR CONTINUED DISCOVERY

Portfolio readiness
Across the corporate-function backlog, where is the combination of business ownership, data readiness, and measurable friction strongest today?

Team operating model
How will peer directors and the new enterprise AI engineers divide portfolio priority, technical ownership, governance coordination, and reusable-pattern stewardship?

Production evidence
What evidence must a workflow produce before PNC is comfortable moving it from an evaluation posture into production?

Primary constraint
Where is the greatest friction today: intake quality, source authority and lineage, capability selection, approvals, engineering capacity, or adoption?

Ninety-day success
What would make the leadership team say after 90 days that this role materially improved how AI opportunities become governed work?

Learning return
How should lessons from one function be shared across the SWAT team without forcing a local workflow into a rigid enterprise template?

Evidence boundary. This thesis reflects broad mandate signals from the hiring conversation and public PNC materials. Specific internal processes, reporting relationships, architecture, data conditions, and approval paths remain subjects for discovery with their accountable owners.

Public sources include PNC's 2025 Annual Report and public Responsible AI materials. Candidate evidence is limited to verified roles, work, and claim strength. This is independent candidate work and is not an official PNC framework or publication.